Behavioural Psychology

Individual Reflective Assignments — Course: 21GNH401TA

Course:	21GNH401TA Behavioral Psychology
Student Name:	Ashita
Roll Number:	RA2311003010323

Assignment 1: Understanding Yourself for Effectiveness

Based on Unit 1 – Understanding Self for Effectiveness

Q1. Positive vs. Negative Self-Concept

Positive statements: I am a caring friend. I work hard even when it is difficult. I learn quickly from my mistakes. I am creative when I put my mind to it. I am honest with the people I trust. I am a supportive family member. I have a good sense of humour. I am curious about the world. I am capable of achieving my goals. I am resilient in the face of setbacks.

Negative statements: I sometimes feel I am not smart enough. I worry too much about what others think of me. I doubt myself before trying new things.

Reflection: When I honestly look at my self-talk, the positive statements feel more familiar during calm moments, but on stressful days the negative thoughts tend to surface more loudly. I notice that my inner critic often shows up right before exams or presentations, which tells me I still need to work on building a steadier, more consistent positive self-image in high-pressure situations.

Q2. Self-Concept Circle

Body: I feel comfortable in my body most of the time, though I sometimes wish I were more physically active. I try to take care of my health by sleeping well and eating regularly. Personality: I see myself as an empathetic and thoughtful person. I tend to listen before I speak, which my friends appreciate. Abilities: I am good at writing and explaining ideas clearly. I am still developing my confidence in mathematics and technical subjects. Role in family: I am the eldest child, which means I often take on a responsible and guiding role. My family relies on me to stay level-headed. Hardest section: The 'Abilities' section was hardest to write because acknowledging both strengths and gaps honestly felt uncomfortable. I tend to downplay my abilities to avoid sounding arrogant, which itself reveals something important about how I see myself.

Q3. Twenty Statements Test — Who Am I?

Based on Self-Concept

1. I am a student. (Social)
2. I am a daughter. (Social)
3. I am a good listener. (Psychological)
4. I am 20 years old. (Physical)
5. I am someone who overthinks. (Psychological)
6. I am a bookworm. (Psychological)
7. I am a friend who shows up. (Social)
8. I am shorter than average. (Physical)

9. I am someone who finds meaning in small things. (Psychological)
10. I am still figuring out my path. (Psychological)

Reflection: Psychological statements form the largest part of my list (5 of 10), followed by Social (3), Physical (2). This suggests that I currently understand myself mainly through my inner qualities, thoughts, and values, while the other parts also contribute to my identity.

Q4. The Wheel of Emotions

During my final semester project presentation last month, I experienced a strong blended emotion. The five core emotions I can identify were: excitement (about sharing months of hard work), anxiety (about being judged), pride (in having completed the project), anticipation (about the outcome), and vulnerability (from being so exposed). What triggered this combination was standing in front of my professors knowing that everything I had worked on was about to be evaluated in a matter of minutes. The blend was overwhelming but also oddly energising.

Q5. The Feeling Wheel — Naming My Emotions

During a group study session last week, I felt deeply overlooked. We were discussing assignment strategies and whenever I offered a suggestion, the conversation quickly moved on without acknowledging it, only for someone else to say the same thing moments later and receive appreciation. What triggered this was the pattern repeating itself three times in the same evening. I responded by going quiet for the rest of the session, which I later realised was not the healthiest way to handle it. I should have voiced how I was feeling instead of withdrawing.

Q6. Reframing a Challenge Optimistically

Initial feeling: I failed a mid-semester test I had prepared well for. My first thought was, "I am just not cut out for this subject. No matter how hard I try, I always fall short." I felt ashamed and considered dropping the elective entirely.

Reframed version: The result was disappointing, but it was one test on one day — not a verdict on my intelligence. Looking back, my preparation style did not match what the exam actually tested. This is temporary and specific, not permanent or personal. I can speak to the professor, adjust my approach, and do better in the final.

What changed: The reframe shifted the cause from 'who I am' to 'what I did differently this time,' which made the problem feel solvable rather than hopeless. That small shift in language changed how motivated I felt to try again.

Q7. My Optimism Test Result

I took the Psychology Today Optimism Test and scored in the moderate range, described as 'cautiously optimistic.' This matches how I see myself quite well — I do not tend to catastrophise, but I am also not naturally the most positive person in the room. When setbacks happen, I usually allow myself a day to feel low, then gradually work toward a plan. I think my moderate optimism protects me from both naive overconfidence and paralysing pessimism, though I would like to push it slightly higher.

Q8. Why Self-Awareness Matters to Me

Self-awareness matters to me because it is the difference between reacting to life and consciously choosing how to respond. Without it, I would keep repeating the same patterns without understanding why. One real example: I used to get unusually irritable the night before any important event. For a long time I snapped at my family without understanding why. Once I noticed the pattern — that my irritability was actually displaced anxiety — I was able to name it, warn people around me, and use breathing exercises instead of taking my stress out on others. That one insight genuinely improved my relationships at home.

Q9. My Johari Window

Open (known to self and others): I am a good listener. My friends and family often come to me first when they need someone to talk to, and I know this about myself too. Hidden (known to self, hidden from others): I am much more afraid of disappointing people than I ever let on. I often agree to things just to avoid being seen as difficult, even when it costs me time or energy. Blind Spot (known to others, not fully realised by self): My roommate recently told me that I have a habit of subtly changing the subject when conversations get too emotionally intense. I had not noticed this, but once she pointed it out, I began to see it in myself.

Q10. My Self-Esteem Tree

Roots: Family love, the value of honesty I grew up with, and my belief that effort always matters even when results disappoint.

Trunk: My core strengths are empathy, perseverance, and clear communication.

Branches: Student, elder sibling, friend, and emerging researcher.

Leaves: Completing my first solo research presentation, being elected class representative, and maintaining my academic consistency despite a difficult semester.

Fruits: Becoming a psychologist who works in school settings, and being someone my younger siblings look up to.

Reflection: I am proudest of my Leaves — the achievements — not because they are impressive on paper, but because each one required me to push past real self-doubt. They remind me that I am capable of more than I believe I am on my harder days.

Assignment 2: Thinking, Problem-Solving & Life Skills

Based on Unit 2 (Problem Solving & Creativity) and Unit 3 (Life Skills)

Q1. Opening My Mind

If humans could only communicate through images, my daily life would change dramatically. In class, taking notes would become a series of sketches rather than words, which would slow me down but also force me to truly understand concepts rather than just transcribe them. Friendships would become more creative and expressive, since we would have to find visual metaphors for complex feelings. This exercise showed me how heavily I rely on verbal thinking. Most of my internal problem- solving is in words, so removing language would genuinely disorient me and push me to think spatially in ways I rarely practise.

Q2. Thinking About My Thinking

1. Whether I had replied to a message — past.
2. What I would do after finishing this assignment — future.
3. Whether I am preparing well enough for exams — myself.
4. Whether a friend who seemed quiet this morning is upset about something — someone else.
5. How I will explain a concept in an upcoming group presentation — future.

Pattern: My thinking leans toward the future and toward others. I spend a lot of mental energy anticipating things and monitoring people around me. While this makes me thoughtful, it also means I am often not fully present in the current moment.

Q3. Fast vs. Slow Thinking in My Life

Fast thinking decisions: (1) Choosing what to eat for lunch without looking at a menu. (2) Deciding to stay in and study on a rainy evening. (3) Saying yes to helping a friend move furniture without asking for details.

Slow thinking decisions: (1) Deciding which elective to choose for the next semester, which took three days of weighing options. (2) Figuring out how to address a conflict with a classmate, where I drafted what I wanted to say several times. (3) Choosing between two internship opportunities by making a pros-and-cons list. The slow thinking decisions consistently led to better outcomes because I had considered more angles. My fast decision to help my friend move felt good in the moment but left me exhausted before an important deadline the next day — a consequence I would have foreseen with more reflection.

Q4. Reverse Thinking — Flip It Around

To ruin my time management, I would:

1. Never write a to-do list → Flip: Write a prioritised daily list each morning.
2. Check my phone every five minutes → Flip: Use phone-free study blocks of 45 minutes.
3. Leave all tasks to the last hour → Flip: Break tasks into small steps and start early.
4. Say yes to every request → Flip: Politely decline tasks that do not serve my priorities.
5. Treat every task as equally urgent → Flip: Categorise by urgency and importance.
6. Never review what I completed → Flip: Spend five minutes each night reviewing progress. This

exercise surprised me because seeing the bad habits written plainly made me realise I was already doing several of them, particularly checking my phone and not reviewing progress. Identify an unhelpful habit Flip it into a positive action Practise the action regularly Review and adjust progress Fig. 2.1: Reverse-thinking process

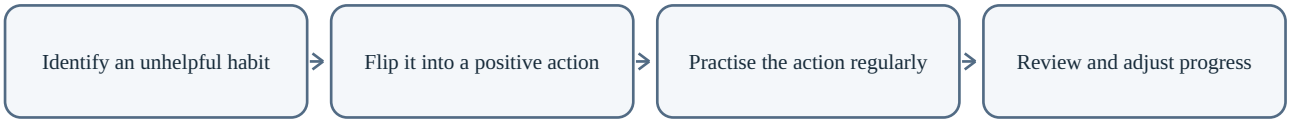


Fig. 2.1: Reverse-thinking process

Q5. My Personal SWOT

Area chosen: Communication Skills

Strengths: I listen actively without interrupting; I express ideas clearly in writing; I adapt my tone based on who I am speaking to.

Weaknesses: I struggle to speak confidently in large group settings; I sometimes over-explain and lose the listener's attention; I avoid confrontational conversations even when necessary.

Opportunities: My college has a public speaking club I have not yet joined; group presentations this semester give me regular practice; a mentor I admire has offered to give me feedback on my communication style.

Threats: Social anxiety tends to worsen under pressure; relying on written communication means I am not growing my verbal skills; peers who dominate discussions can make me retreat further.

Q6. Active Listening in Practice

I asked my younger sister to speak to me for two minutes about her day. She described a situation at school where a group project had fallen apart because one member was not contributing, and how she had to step up and redo a section herself the night before the submission. She was frustrated but also quietly proud of having managed it alone.

Reflection: The hardest part was not jumping in with solutions or reassurances. My instinct was to say 'that's not fair, you should tell the teacher,' but I held back. I realised that most of the time people do not want to be fixed — they want to feel heard. Restraining that impulse was genuinely uncomfortable and illuminating.

Q7. The Floor Is Yours

Prompt chosen: (a) A motivating speech to a friend who just failed an exam. "Hey, I know this hurts. And I am not going to tell you it doesn't matter, because I know it does to you — and that actually says something good about who you are. You care. That is not a weakness. But here is what I need you to remember: one result does not define what you are capable of. Think about how many times you have figured things out that seemed impossible at first. This is one more of those moments, not proof that you cannot do it. What would change if you approached the next attempt like it was your first real shot, without the weight of this one? Because it is. You still have that chance. So let's figure out what needs to be different — together."

Q8. Stepping Into Empathy

During a college trip last year, one of my quieter classmates received news that her grandmother had passed away. She did not cry in front of anyone, but I noticed her sitting very still, staring at her phone while everyone else was laughing. I felt a sudden heaviness in my chest — a recognition of that specific loneliness of receiving painful news in a crowd. I did not say much; I just moved to sit next to her and stayed there quietly. She later told me that was exactly what she had needed. This moment changed how I act — I learned that empathy often does not require words. Presence itself is a form of care.

Q9. Treating Others Respectfully

Based on Respect

1. My father: I show respect by listening carefully to his advice and keeping him informed about important decisions. I try not to dismiss his concerns, even when I am busy.

2. My mother: I show respect by making time to talk to her and by helping with responsibilities at home. I know I can sometimes become impatient when I am stressed, so I want to respond more calmly.

3. My teacher: I show respect by attending class on time, listening without interrupting, and asking questions politely when I need clarification.

Honest evaluation: I try to show respect to all three consistently, but I can improve by being more patient with my parents and more prompt in following my teacher's instructions.

Q10. Building It Back Up — Resilience

In my second semester, I had been working on a research proposal for nearly six weeks. Three days before submission, my laptop crashed and I lost a large portion of work I had not backed up. I sat on the floor of my room for about an hour just staring at the ceiling. I genuinely considered submitting an incomplete draft and accepting the lower grade. What helped me rebuild was my roommate bringing me tea without saying anything, and then sitting with me as I slowly reconstructed what I could from memory and browser history. What I found was that I remembered more than I thought I did — the ideas were still in my head, just not on the screen. That realisation shifted something. I submitted on time, and the final version was actually cleaner. The experience taught me that resilience is not about pretending setbacks do not hurt. It is about not letting the worst hour become the final answer.

Assignment 3: Stress, Personality & Socialization

Based on Unit 4 (Stress & Coping) and Unit 5 (Personality, Socialization & Human Values)

Q1. Sorting My Stress

Controllable Uncontrollable

1. Poor time management with assignments
1. Unexpected changes in examination schedules
2. Irregular sleep schedule
2. A family member's ongoing health issue
3. Not reviewing lecture notes regularly
3. Conflict within my project group caused by another member's behaviour Sorting these into two columns was eye-opening. I realised that more of my stress comes from controllable sources than I had assumed. That means more of it is actually in my hands to address.

Q2. Recognising My Own Stress Symptoms

Physical: When I am under heavy academic stress, my neck and shoulders become noticeably tense, especially by late evening. I often do not notice it until I try to turn my head.

Emotional: I become irritable and unusually sensitive to small things — a delayed reply to a message, for instance, can feel disproportionately upsetting when I am already stressed.

Cognitive: I experience a kind of mental fog where I read the same paragraph three times without retaining it. Decision-making also becomes harder than usual.

Behavioural: I avoid starting tasks I know are important, substituting them with low-effort activities like scrolling or rearranging my desk — a pattern I now recognise as stress avoidance.

Q3. The 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Exercise

5 things I can see: My study lamp, an open notebook, a potted plant on the windowsill, the ceiling fan, and my water bottle. 4 things I can touch: The smooth surface of my desk, the slight texture of my pen, the softness of my chair fabric, and the warmth of my own hands resting on the table. 3 things I can hear: A distant bird outside, the gentle hum of the fan, and the occasional sound of footsteps in the corridor. 2 things I can smell: The faint scent of the room freshener and the paper of my notebook. 1 thing I can taste: A mild bitterness from the tea I had a few minutes ago.

Reflection: Yes, it did shift something. After completing the exercise, I felt measurably less scattered. It did not solve anything, but it brought me back to the present moment in a way that reduced the mental noise enough to continue working.

Q4. Nature Journaling

I sat under the large neem tree at the edge of our college campus for ten minutes in the late afternoon. I noticed the dappled light shifting as the branches moved slightly in the breeze. Two sparrows were picking at something near the base of the tree, moving in quick precise bursts. The air smelled faintly of earth and green. A line of ants moved steadily along a crack in the pathway, unbothered by anything around them. By the time I stood up, I noticed I had been breathing more slowly without deciding to. My stress level had not disappeared, but it had receded enough to feel manageable. I think what nature does is remind you that the world is continuing its patterns regardless of your deadlines — and that is both humbling and oddly comforting.

Q5. My Go-To Coping Strategy

My go-to coping strategy is music and movement — specifically, putting on a playlist and walking around my room or outside for ten to fifteen minutes when I feel overwhelmed. It is not structured exercise, just movement with something to listen to. Honestly, it is a temporary escape more than a solution — it does not make the assignment go away or resolve the conflict. But it reliably breaks the cycle of anxious thoughts long enough for me to return to the problem with a slightly clearer head. I think it works because it engages my body and shifts my attention just enough to interrupt the spiral. For now, it is the most accessible tool I have, and I use it deliberately rather than as pure avoidance. Notice stress signals Pause and identify the cause Choose a healthy coping action Reflect, recover and reset Fig. 3.1: Healthy coping sequence

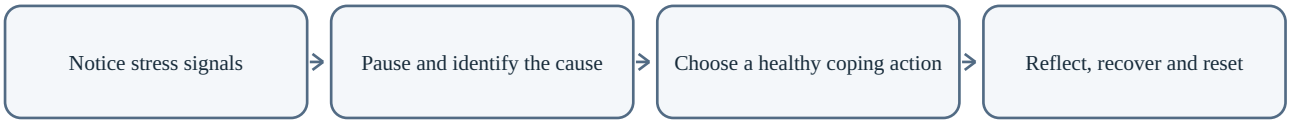


Fig. 3.1: Healthy coping sequence

Q6. My Big Five Personality Profile

I took the Big Five test at bigfive-test.com. My scores were approximately: Openness: 78 | Conscientiousness: 62 | Extraversion: 41 | Agreeableness: 74 | Neuroticism: 58 These results match how I see myself fairly well. The high Openness reflects my genuine curiosity and love of ideas. The moderate-to-high Agreeableness aligns with how much I value harmony in relationships. The lower Extraversion is accurate — I recharge alone and large social settings drain me. The moderate Neuroticism is honest; I do experience emotional ups and downs, particularly around performance. The only slight surprise was my Conscientiousness score — I expected it to be higher given how seriously I take responsibilities, but on reflection, my tendency to procrastinate probably pulls that number down.

Q7. My Personality Type in Action

I identify most strongly with high Agreeableness from the Big Five framework. A specific real-life example: during a group project this semester, there was significant disagreement about which research direction to take. Two members were quite firm about their individual preferences. Rather than taking a side, I found myself naturally working as a mediator — listening to both arguments carefully, finding the parts that could actually coexist, and proposing a combined approach that neither person had considered. The group ultimately went with my suggestion. This trait serves me well in collaborative settings, but I also recognise its shadow: I sometimes suppress my own preferences to maintain group harmony, which is not always healthy or productive.

Q8. Learning the Unwritten Rules

When I first joined a psychology study group in my second semester, I quickly realised there were unwritten rules I had to figure out. The group had a strong norm of referencing theoretical frameworks in every discussion — if you just shared an opinion without grounding it in a concept, you were met with polite but unmistakable scepticism. No one told me this; I noticed it after my first contribution was received with quiet indifference while a more theoretically framed one from another member received enthusiastic engagement. I adapted by reading more widely and learning to anchor my thoughts in frameworks before sharing them. I stayed true to myself by ensuring the frameworks I cited were ones I genuinely believed in, not ones I was using just to fit in.

Q9. A Different Perspective

My closest college friend, Nadia, grew up in a family with a different religious background than mine. Early in our friendship, I noticed she had a very different relationship with silence — in her home, sitting quietly together was considered a form of closeness, not awkwardness. For me, raised in a

household where silence often meant tension, this was completely new. What I learned from her was that the absence of words does not mean the absence of connection. She also taught me, without ever saying it directly, that my habit of filling every quiet moment with conversation was sometimes about my own discomfort, not about the other person's need. That was something I genuinely had not known before, and it changed how I show up in relationships.

Q10. My Code of Ethics

In my first year, I was part of a small group working on a submission. One night, before the deadline, I discovered that one member had copied large sections from an online source without citing it. He asked me to let it go — 'everyone does it,' he said, 'and it will only hurt the group if you say something now.' The easy path was to stay quiet. I genuinely considered it. But I could not submit work I knew was dishonest, so I spoke to him directly and gave him the night to rewrite his section with proper citations. I told him I would not go to the faculty if he fixed it. He was upset, but he did it. The value that guided me was integrity — not as a rule, but as something I need to live with. Yes, I would make the same choice again. The short-term discomfort was real, but I would not have been able to put my name on that work otherwise.